Understanding GLP-1 Agonists

The newest class of weight-loss medications — how they work, what to expect, and which options are available

🔬 WHAT ARE GLP-1 AGONISTS?

GLP-1 (Glucagon-Like Peptide-1) receptor agonists are **injectable medications** that mimic a natural gut hormone. They are approved to treat type 2 diabetes AND obesity.

🍽️ **After eating:** Triggers insulin release from the pancreas — lowers blood sugar

🔁 **Liver:** Reduces glucose production — helps blood sugar control

🐌 **Stomach emptying:** Slows digestion — you feel fuller, longer

🧠 **Brain signals:** Decreases appetite and food cravings

🎯 **Result: Less hunger + smaller portions + lower blood sugar = significant weight loss**

💊 AVAILABLE GLP-1 MEDICATIONS

Liraglutide Daily injection
Saxenda® (obesity) · Victoza® (diabetes)
Dose: 0.6 → 3.0 mg SC daily (weekly titration) · **~5–10% weight loss**

Semaglutide Weekly injection
Wegovy® (obesity) · Ozempic® (diabetes)
Dose: 0.25 → 2.4 mg SC weekly · **~15% weight loss**

Tirzepatide (GLP-1 + GIP) Dual agonist
Zepbound® (obesity) · Mounjaro® (diabetes)
Dose: 2.5 → 15 mg SC weekly · ⭐ **~20–25% weight loss**

Also available: Dulaglutide (Trulicity), Exenatide (Bydureon) — primarily for diabetes

⚠️ SIDE EFFECTS

Common (usually improve over time)

- 🤢 Nausea — most common, especially when starting
- 💩 Diarrhea or constipation
- 🤮 Vomiting (less common)
- 😔 Decreased appetite (this is the intended effect!)
- 🤕 Headache, fatigue, dizziness

🚨 Serious — Contact Us Right Away

- URGENT Severe abdominal pain (possible pancreatitis)
- URGENT Neck mass or difficulty swallowing (thyroid concern)
- URGENT Signs of severe allergic reaction
- URGENT Vision changes (diabetic retinopathy worsening)
- URGENT Kidney problems — reduced urination, swelling

🚫 WHO SHOULD NOT USE GLP-1 AGONISTS

- CI Personal *or family* history of **medullary thyroid cancer**
- CI Multiple Endocrine Neoplasia syndrome type 2 (MEN 2)
- CI History of **pancreatitis** or gallbladder disease
- CI Severe gastrointestinal disease
- CI **Pregnancy** or planning to become pregnant
- CI Known hypersensitivity to any component

💊 Drug Interactions:
• Insulin or sulfonylureas — risk of low blood sugar; monitor closely
• GLP-1 agents slow gastric emptying — may affect oral medication absorption (take critical medications 1 hour before injection)

⭐ The Science Behind Your Success

GLP-1 agonists represent one of the most significant advances in obesity medicine in decades. Nausea is common at the start — it almost always improves within 4–6 weeks as your body adjusts. Slow titration is key. These medications work best alongside **regular follow-up, healthy eating habits, and movement**. We're here to customize your plan and answer every question. 💚 — (281) 557-0300